

LOAN APPLICATION FORM

Welcome to BCRS

Thank you for approaching BCRS Business Loans ("BCRS"). We believe in supporting SMEs who cannot access the finance they need from traditional lenders.

We are committed to supporting SMEs that are making a positive contribution to the social, economic and environmental wellbeing of the communities they serve, and ask applicants to demonstrate this as part of our process.

How to apply

- 1) **Checklist** – We have produced a helpful checklist to guide you through the key eligibility criteria, as well as links to the supporting information we need to progress your loan application.
- 2) **Application Form** – Please complete the remainder of this form and return via



Email

enquiries@bcrs.org.uk



Post

BCRS Business Loans
Technology Centre,
Wolverhampton Science
Park, Glaisher Drive,
Wolverhampton, WV10 9RU



Direct

Hand your application
form to a member of
our team

- 3) **That's it for now** – A member of our team will then be in touch to guide you through the process, arrange a fact finding meeting with you, and let you know if we require further supporting information.

Essential Reading

Please read our **Key Facts Document** and visit our website at www.bcrs.org.uk to find out more about our Eligibility Criteria and terms of our business loans.

BCRS takes any expressions of dissatisfaction seriously. Please visit <https://bcrs.org.uk/complaints-process> should you have any concerns about our loan application process.

If you have any queries at this stage, please do not hesitate to contact us on **0345 313 8410** or email: customerrelations@bcrs.org.uk

Supported by



BCRS Business Loans is a registered society, number 29393R, under the co-operative and Community Societies Act 2014. We are authorised and regulated by the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA), Firm Reference Number 722855. For more details, please contact the FCA at www.fca.org.uk or on 0800 111 6768.

Supported by Nations and Regions Investment Limited, a subsidiary of British Business Bank plc, the Bank is a development bank wholly owned by HM Government. Neither Nations and Regions Investment Limited nor British Business Bank plc are authorised or regulated by the Prudential Regulation Authority (PRA) or the Financial Conduct Authority (FCA).

The Growth Guarantee Scheme is managed by the British Business Bank on behalf of, and with the financial backing of, the Secretary of State for Business & Trade. British Business Bank plc is a development bank wholly owned by HM Government. It is not authorised or regulated by the PRA or the FCA. Visit www.british-business-bank.co.uk/finance-options/debt-finance/growth-guarantee-scheme.

Eligibility Criteria

As a responsible lender, we meet certain eligibility criteria to ensure we are lending to viable businesses who meet the requirements of our funders. All loans are subject to status, location and our credit policy. Please see below:

Legal entity	Loans are available to Limited Companies, Sole Traders, Partnerships and Social						
Loan amount	Enterprise Between £10,000 - £250,000						
Loan term	Between 1 to 7 years						
Interest rate	Typically between 8% to 18% either Fixed or Variable*, subject to availability						
Arrangement fees	Between 3% - 5%**						
Exclusions	Most sectors will be considered however there are a few <u>exclusions</u>: 1. Property investment and development 2. Services already covered by local government schemes, such as education, social welfare, sports, local leisure and cultural facilities 3. Gambling 4. Tobacco – either involved in the distribution of or solely derived from the sale of tobacco 5. Ethically unsound businesses						
Other	Payment holidays considered for periods of up to 12 months in exceptional circumstances No early repayment fees Penalty fees are applied as follows: <table><tr><td>- Bounced cheques or Returned Direct Debits</td><td>£20</td></tr><tr><td>- Direct Debit Mandates cancelled without authorisation</td><td>£35</td></tr><tr><td>- Rescheduling Loan Repayments</td><td>1% of outstanding loan</td></tr></table>	- Bounced cheques or Returned Direct Debits	£20	- Direct Debit Mandates cancelled without authorisation	£35	- Rescheduling Loan Repayments	1% of outstanding loan
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Security	The following security will be taken for limited companies: - o Debenture https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l4DBsyWNIAc - o Personal Guarantee: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OfpMCPLWDbM Further security may be required Some applications may be eligible for government-backed Guarantee Schemes, which we deliver in partnership with the British Business Bank						
Reporting	Financial information and other Data on the impact of your loan will need to be supplied to meet our funding requirements.						

* If the base rate changes, your loan repayments will stay the same, but the term of your loan will be extended / reduced accordingly.

**Where security is being taken, additional costs may apply may affect the overall cost of your borrowing

Basic Information

The first part of your application requires you to provide key information about you and your business.

Where did you hear about us?	
Is this the first time you will be in receipt of any type of external, repayable finance? E.g. Overdrafts/ Loans/ HP/ Asset Finance/ Invoice Finance	☐ YES ☐ NO

Business Name	
Business Address/Postcode (not registered office)	
Legal Entity	☐ Sole Trader ☐ Partnership ☐ Limited Company or LLP ☐ Social Enterprise
Company Number (for Ltd Co/LLP/social entity)	
Unique Tax Reference/ VAT Number (for sole traders and partnerships)	
What does the business do?	
Start Date of Trading	
Business Location (where will your business pay rates to?)	
Business Telephone No	
Website Address (if available)	

Contact Name	
Contact Telephone No	
Contact Email Address	
Position within the business	

Loan Amount	
Purpose of Loan <i>A breakdown of how you will use the loan</i>	
Required Term	

Name of Bank & Branch			
Name of Business Manager			
Telephone Number		Email Address	

Name of Accountancy Practice			
Name of Accountant			
Telephone Number		Email Address	

Please answer the following questions truthfully, as the answer will have a bearing on our ability to progress your application.

Has this business been subject to any insolvency proceedings, such as a Company Voluntary Liquidation, Administration or County Court Judgments?	☐ YES ☐ NO
If yes, please provide full details	
Have the directors/owners ever been associated, personally or as an official, with a failed business enterprise?	☐ YES ☐ NO
If yes, please provide full details	
Have the directors/owners personally been subject to any insolvency proceedings, such as an Individual Voluntary Arrangement, Bankruptcy, County Court Judgment or Debt Management Plan?	☐ YES ☐ NO
If yes, please provide full details	

Social and Economic Impact

Applicants will need to confirm what previous support they have received and demonstrate the positive social and economic contribution of their business to the local community.

Has your business been in receipt of any State Aid or subsidy over the last 3 years? Examples includes - Recovery Loan Scheme (RLS) since August 2022 - Growth Guarantee Scheme (GGS) since July 2024 Please note that if you are successful in receiving support from the Growth Guarantee Scheme, this will be considered a subsidy				☐ YES ☐ NO	
If yes, how much State Aid was received? Please refer to your State Aid/subsidy letter from your lender – this is NOT the amount of your loan)			£		
If you are unable to provide your State Aid/subsidy letter(s), then please provide details of the loan type i.e. RLS or GGS amount borrowed, term of the loan and date drawn					
	Total	Full Time		Part Time	
		Male	Female	Male	Female
How many employees do you have? (include directors)					
How many jobs will the business be creating by taking out this loan?					
How many jobs will the business be protecting by taking out this loan?					
How will the loan protect these jobs/ sales for at least a year?					
Which jobs are at risk/being protected?					
What anticipated job roles will be created with this loan?					
Business turnover/sales for the last quarter					
Your lender will use and rely on your answers in this questionnaire when processing your application. (Applicant will be an NI applicant if it answers yes to both questions)					
1. Is your business involved in the manufacture or sales of goods¹ or does it operate in the Northern Ireland Wholesale Electricity Market² (or have plans to start manufacturing or selling such goods or to operate in the Northern Ireland Wholesale Electricity Market in the next three years)?				☐ YES ☐ NO	
If the answer is yes, then go to question 2. If the answer is no, then the Subsidy Control Act will apply and you can skip question 2.					
2. Is your business (this is the legal entity proposing to borrow the GGS facility) established or registered in Northern Ireland?				☐ YES ☐ NO	
If the answer is yes, then the European State aid rules will apply If the answer is no, then the Subsidy Control Act will apply. Note that if your main place of business is in Northern Ireland, but the entity intending to borrow the GGS facility is established in Great Britain and intends to apply the proceeds of the GGS facility in Great Britain, then the Subsidy Control Act will apply.					

¹ The manufacturing and sale of goods would include the primary production of agricultural products or the production, processing or marketing of fishery and aquaculture products.

² This means the Northern Ireland/Ireland single Electricity market specifically in relation to the generation, transmission, distribution, or supply of wholesale electricity.

Data Consent and Declaration

To be able to proceed with your loan application we next require your consent to hold your data.

PRIVACY STATEMENT

As a responsible lender, BCRS Business Loans Limited is committed to protecting the data that we collect to provide the investments into SME businesses we support. We only gather information for the purposes of assessing, disbursing and monitoring the loans we make. We do not buy or sell Personal Data, and we only share a limited amount of data to a small number of trusted organisations who are vital in their support of BCRS. Our staff care about you and your business, and this means we are dedicated to making sure your data is safe and secure here at BCRS.

For more information about how your information is used, how we maintain the security of your information, and your rights to access information held on you, please visit <https://bcrs.org.uk/privacy-policy/>.

BCRS is supported by a variety of funding organisations, whom themselves are required to collect information about you and your business to process, monitor and assess their specific fund. It also helps them to develop new services and maintain fraud prevention. For more information on where your data is held, please contact BCRS in the first instance.

We now need you to 'opt in' to allow us to hold your data. Please tick the following boxes if you agree.

- ☐ I / We consent to BCRS Business Loans Limited holding my / our data for the purpose of assessing, disbursing and monitoring business loans.
- ☐ I / We consent to BCRS Business Loans Limited sharing this information with its affiliated organisations for the purposes detailed above.
- ☐ I / We authorise BCRS Business Loans Limited to make any credit reference and other enquiries in accordance with normal procedures for this application.
- ☐ I / We agree that BCRS Business Loans Limited, and affiliated organisations, may use our name in its publicity material and in the provision of data for funders.

Marketing:

- ☐ I / We consent to receive further communications from BCRS Business Loans Limited regarding related services and products that I might be interested in.
- ☐ I / We consent to receive communications from affiliated organisations regarding services and products that might be interested in.

I consent to being contacted via the following methods: ☐ Post ☐ Email ☐ Telephone

Declaration:

- ☐ I / We confirm that the information provided is true, accurate and complete in every respect, and that all material particulars have been disclosed, to the best of my / our knowledge.
- ☐ I / We understand that the information provided may form the basis of any contract between the applicant and BCRS.

BCRS Business Loans Ltd is committed to reducing its carbon footprint and therefore send out Annual Statements via the email address provided. Please tick the following box if you would prefer paper statements to be sent: ☐

Is there an alternative email address you would like private and confidential information to be sent to:

Signature(s) of Director(s)

Date

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